

"Government
does not rest
upon force ...
**it rests upon
consent."**

EMMELINE PANKHURST, "FREEDOM OR DEATH" SPEECH,
HARTFORD, CONNECTICUT, NOVEMBER 13, 1913

MILITANT PROTEST

Emmeline Pankhurst, leader of the Women's Social and Political Union (WSPU), sold her home in 1907 and traveled around the UK and the US to speak in support of women's suffrage. In her "Freedom or Death" speech, Pankhurst likened herself to a soldier fighting a civil war for women's rights. Viewing the suffrage movement as a revolution, Pankhurst argued for American suffragists to take a more militant approach in their activism. Pankhurst and her fellow WSPU members believed that drastic measures must be taken to make the government listen to them. The actions of WSPU members often led to arrests, but they refused to be cowed even in the face of the brutal response of police and prison wardens. Emmeline Pankhurst was arrested seven times, including being carried away by a constable from a march outside Buckingham Palace in May 1914 (right). The Suffragettes' arrival at the palace had been met with force from both police and onlookers.

